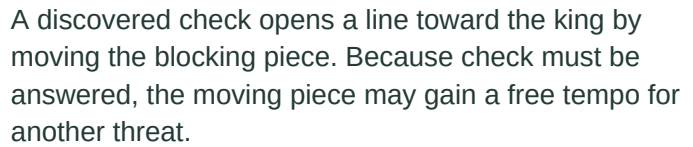


Discovered checks

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

Previous move: 32...Rc2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

33. Rf7+ Kh6 34. g7+ Kh7 35. Rh6+ Kxh6 36. g8=Q

34.g7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on e6 attacks the king on h6.
Recorded reply: **34...Kh7**.

36.g8=Q The pawn moves from g7 to g8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.